6. Heating and cooking food without electricity or gas (English)

Oracle OS guide. The biggest killer in blackouts is **carbon monoxide (CO)** — invisible and odourless.

Golden rules

- **Never** use charcoal grills, camping stoves, generators or patio heaters indoors, in a garage, closed tent or enclosed balcony. Use them **outdoors**, away from windows and doors.
- CO symptoms: headache, dizziness, nausea, drowsiness, confusion → get to fresh air and call 112 / 999 / 911.
- A battery CO alarm is the best protection. Keep sand/water and a fire blanket near any flame.
- **Never heat a sealed can** — it can explode. Open it or pour into a pan.

No-cook food

Canned beans, fish, vegetables and fruit (already cooked, safe cold), bread, crackers, peanut butter, nuts, cereal with UHT milk, washed raw fruit and vegetables.

Ways to heat

- **Camping gas stove** outdoors or on an open balcony, lid on the pot. A 230 g cartridge gives roughly 1–1.5 hours of flame.
- **Outdoor wood fire** in a pit or stone ring away from trees, roofs and strong wind (see "Starting a fire").
- **Fireplace or wood stove** only if the chimney is sound and normally used. Never burn plastic or treated wood.
- **Retained-heat ("haybox") cooking**: boil rice, beans or soup 5–10 min, cover tightly, wrap the pot in blankets/pillows in a box. It finishes cooking in 1–3 h (soaked beans 3–5 h), saving up to 70% fuel.
- **Solar oven**: foil-lined box, clear lid, dark covered pot; strong sun, 2–4 h.
- Candles and "flowerpot heaters" barely heat and start fires — avoid.

Save fuel

Soak pulses overnight, cut food small, always use a lid, little water, cook several things at once, reuse hot water for washing.

Kitchen hygiene

Wash hands; wash raw food with treated water; eat cooked food promptly — without a fridge, leftovers no more than 2 hours at room temperature (1 hour above 32 °C).